SelfHelp

Technology Platform for Research

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SelfHelp: A Platform for Digital Programs, Research and Support

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- SelfHelp began as a self-help and research website platform
- It has grown into a modular system for content, data, workflows, mobile, and AI
- It is designed for real programs, not just isolated pages or forms
- The value is practical: build, run, adapt, and monitor digital interventions in one place

What SelfHelp Is

- A modular platform for building digital programs with reusable components
- The same system handles content, data collection, automation, permissions, and mobile output
- It supports institutional hosting and strong control over sensitive data
- Many use cases can be configured through the CMS rather than custom-coded from scratch
- A plugin architecture allows the platform to grow without breaking the core

How SelfHelp Evolved

- 2021: positioned as a platform for self-help and research websites
- 2023: expanded toward modular pages, scheduling, and mobile integration
- 2024 to 2026: stronger data model, workflows, permissions, 2FA, and live refresh mechanisms
- The newest step is AI: general LLM support and supervised therapy-style chat
- The direction is clear: from content publishing toward structured digital program delivery

What Teams Can Achieve with It

- Launch digital programs that combine information, interaction, and follow-up
- Collect structured data, repeated measures, files, voice, and media
- Personalize journeys by role, group, language, condition, or user state
- Automate reminders, notifications, tasks, and triggered actions
- Reach users on web and mobile through one platform logic

Why SelfHelp Works as a Platform, Not Just a Tool

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- The core already covers pages, sections, dataTables, conditions, workflows, and ACL
- The API layer and mobile rendering connect web, app, and external services
- Survey, experiment, and assessment plugins extend the platform beyond classic forms
- Analysis and scoring can be pushed further through formula and R-based extensions
- SSO, sensing, notifications, and video integrations make institutional deployment more realistic

Focus Plugin 1: SurveyJS

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- Advanced survey creation with versioning, publishing, and scheduling
- Supports autosave, timing metadata, edit mode, access control, and dashboards
- Handles files, PDF export, and voice-record responses
- Allows dynamic content such as API-driven dropdowns and JSON replacement
- Strong fit for repeated assessments, diaries, intake flows, and structured questionnaires

Focus Plugin 2: LLM

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- Adds configurable AI assistants directly inside SelfHelp pages
- Supports text, files, images, and speech-to-text input
- Can return free conversation or structured JSON and form-like outputs
- Includes reusable prompt scripts, async execution, and admin monitoring
- Prompt Lab enables testing, replay, and evaluation before live rollout

Focus Plugin 3: LLM Therapy Chat

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- Combines patient-facing AI chat with therapist oversight in one conversation space
- Therapists get a dashboard with unread counts, alerts, notes, summaries, and drafts
- Users can escalate directly to a human instead of staying only with AI
- Safety logic can block AI and move the case into human-only mode
- The result is a supervised model of AI-supported communication, not an unsupervised bot

Mobile App: Bringing SelfHelp into Daily Use

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- The mobile app uses the same platform logic through mobile-ready JSON output
- It already supports surveys, AI chat, therapy chat, notifications, camera, and microphone
- This enables repeated interaction in real contexts, not only desktop sessions
- Mobile support increases adherence, timeliness, and day-to-day relevance
- SelfHelp becomes a living service, not just a web portal

How SelfHelp Compares to Existing Open, Self-Hosted Options

- LimeSurvey is excellent for surveys, but it is primarily a survey product
- JATOS and formr are strong for online studies, yet they are less suited to content-rich program delivery
- Moodle is strong for learning delivery, but it is not built around intervention workflows or supervised support logic
- SelfHelp brings content, assessments, workflows, mobile, permissions, and AI into one coherent stack
- Its advantage is not one feature in isolation, but the fact that the pieces already work together

SelfHelp 2: Why the Redesign Matters

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- SelfHelp 2 is moving toward a cleaner API-first backend and modern frontend
- Page structure, section logic, and publishing become more explicit and maintainable
- The new architecture should make future plugins and interfaces easier to build
- A key strategic goal is structured page JSON that LLMs can generate or adapt
- The redesign is therefore not cosmetic; it prepares the platform for faster, safer content creation

Closing: Why SelfHelp Matters Now

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- One platform for digital research, teaching, and support programs
- One structure across web, mobile, workflows, and AI
- One locally controlled foundation that can keep growing with university needs
- SelfHelp 2 can make content creation faster, more structured, and eventually AI-assisted

References

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Thank You

for your Attention

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